

ResearchMindsNet

Submission Templates

Newspaper • Magazine • Book Chapter • Abstract • Poster • Article • Journal

A guideline pack for researchers, innovators, and product developers

How to use this pack

This document contains seven independent submission templates, matching the seven categories in your submission portal: Newspaper, Magazine, Book Chapter, Abstract, Poster, Article, and Journal. Each template begins with a short explanation of the format, a formatting checklist, then labelled fields and shaded fill-in boxes you can type directly into. Italic grey text inside boxes is placeholder guidance — replace it with your own content.

Newspaper and Magazine each carry two parts: a writing template for pieces you author yourself, and a press-coverage log for recording external coverage of your research (for CVs, funder reports, or your communications office).

The templates draw on standards from recognized academic and professional bodies:

- Newspaper op-eds follow word-count and single-argument conventions used across major daily papers' op-ed desks, and public-engagement guidance from the American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS).
- Magazine features follow the narrative-lead-plus-“nut graf” structure documented in journalism craft resources such as The Open Notebook.
- Book chapters follow Springer Nature's published manuscript guidelines for edited-volume contributions, a template widely mirrored by comparable academic publishers.
- Abstracts use the IMRaD structure (Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion/Conclusion), the standard required by most journals indexed in PubMed, Scopus, and Web of Science, per the ICMJE Recommendations.
- Scientific posters use the layout recommended by the NIH and the American Medical Writers Association — a single-glance title bar, a left-to-right reading flow, and a clear visual hierarchy.
- General/trade articles follow conventions typical of professional and industry publications: practitioner-focused, structured with subheadings, light on inline citation.
- Full journal manuscripts follow the ICMJE Recommendations for the Conduct, Reporting, Editing, and Publication of Scholarly Work in Medical Journals, used by more than 5,000 journals worldwide and mirrored by most non-medical journals.

Delete the instructional pages before submitting if your venue asks for the content only.

At a glance

A quick reference across all seven categories. Full detail and fill-in fields for each are in the templates that follow.

Category	Typical length	Core structure	Grounded in
Newspaper	600–800 words	Hook → argument → evidence → call to action	AAAS/SciLine op-ed guidance; op-ed desk conventions
Magazine	800–2,000 words	Narrative hook → nut graf → narrative arc	Feature-writing “nut graf” convention
Book Chapter	5,000–8,000 words (varies)	Abstract → numbered sections → conclusion	Springer Nature chapter manuscript guidelines
Abstract	200–300 words	IMRaD (Background/Aim/Methods/Results/Conclusion)	ICMJE Recommendations
Poster	300–800 words on-panel	Title → Intro → Methods → Results → Discussion → Conclusions	NIH / American Medical Writers Association
Article	800–1,500 words	Hook → context → insight → practical implications	Trade/professional publication conventions
Journal	Journal-specific (full manuscript)	IMRaD + title page + disclosures	ICMJE Recommendations

TEMPLATE 1

Newspaper

Op-ed / guest column, plus a press-coverage log — 600 to 800 words

About this format

A newspaper op-ed argues a single point about a timely issue and asks the reader to accept a conclusion — unlike a straight news story. Word-count conventions across major daily and regional papers converge on roughly 600–800 words, and most desks require exclusivity: a piece submitted to one paper cannot be offered elsewhere until it is declined or published. The checklist below follows public-engagement guidance from the American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS) and the conventions used by op-ed desks at most daily papers.

Formatting checklist

- Word count: 600–800 words (many desks cap at 600–750; confirm the target outlet's own limit before submitting).
- One argument only — do not combine multiple points or asks in a single piece.
- Open with a hook in the first 1–2 sentences: a timely news peg, a vivid scenario, or a striking statistic.
- State your point plainly within the first few paragraphs — don't bury the lede.
- Write for a general reader: no jargon, acronyms, or in-text citations; explain any necessary term in plain language.
- Ground the argument in your expertise or direct experience, and end with a specific, concrete recommendation.
- Submit to one outlet at a time (exclusivity is standard practice) and disclose if the piece has run elsewhere.
- Include full contact details and a one-line institutional bio; a headshot is often requested.

Op-ed — fill in below

Working headline *Editors usually rewrite it, but a clear working title sharpens your framing.*

Type your working headline here.

Target outlet *Newspaper or section you're submitting to.*

e.g. Regional daily, opinion section

Author & one-line bio *Name, title, institution.*

First Last, [title], [institution]

Contact details *Email and phone number.*

name@institution.edu • phone

Hook / opening line *Imagine if ... / Did you know that ... / Last month, ...*

Draft your opening line here.

Core argument *One sentence stating the point of the piece.*

State the single argument you are making.

Supporting evidence *2–3 points, each traceable to a source.*

Point 1 ... Point 2 ... Point 3 ...

Call to action / closing line *What should the reader, policymaker, or institution do next?*

Close with a specific, forward-looking line.

Word count *600–800 target.*

___ words

Press coverage — log a newspaper placement

Use this table to record newspaper coverage of your research for your CV, funder reports, or your institution's communications team.

Outlet	Date	Headline / URL	Journalist	Type	Related output	Reach

TEMPLATE 2

Magazine

Feature article, plus a press-coverage log — 800 to 2,000 words

About this format

A magazine feature builds a narrative around a scene, character, or central question rather than following a news lead. After the narrative opening, the piece needs a “nut graf” — the paragraph, usually the second or third, that tells the reader in a nutshell what the story is about and why it matters, a convention documented across journalism-craft resources such as The Open Notebook. Feature length varies widely by outlet, from short specialist-press pieces to long-form general-interest features.

Formatting checklist

- Word count: typically 800–2,000 words for a feature; trade and specialist-science magazines often run shorter, general-interest and long-form outlets longer — confirm the target publication's own guidelines.
- Structure: narrative opening → nut graf (states the stakes and relevance) → body developed as a narrative arc (setup, development, resolution), not an inverted pyramid → closing that returns to the opening image or question.
- Anchor technical content in a scene, a central character, or a concrete example; translate jargon into plain language on first use.
- Provide a fact-check package: sources, links, and contact details for every named person or figure quoted.
- Suggest 2–3 possible visuals or pull-quotes for the layout editor.
- Byline with a short bio and, if requested, a headshot.

Feature — fill in below

Working title *Often replaced at layout, but keeps the piece focused.*

Type your working title here.

Target magazine / section *Publication and section you're pitching or writing for.*

e.g. Science section, feature well

Author & bio *Name, title, institution, and a one-line bio.*

First Last, [title], [institution]

Opening scene / hook *The scene, anecdote, or question that opens the piece.*

Describe the opening scene here.

Nut graf 1–2 sentences telling the reader what the story is about and why it matters now.

This story is about ... because ...

Section beats / outline 3–5 beats the narrative arc moves through.

Beat 1 ... Beat 2 ... Beat 3 ...

Sources for fact-checking Names, contacts, and links for every claim and quote.

List sources and contact details here.

Suggested visuals Photos, diagrams, or pull-quote candidates.

Describe suggested visuals here.

Word count 800–2,000 target.

___ words

Press coverage — log a magazine placement

Use this table to record magazine coverage of your research for your CV, funder reports, or your institution's communications team.

Outlet	Date	Headline / URL	Journalist	Type	Related output	Reach

TEMPLATE 3

Book Chapter

Edited-volume contribution

About this format

A book chapter for an edited academic volume is prepared to the publisher's house style rather than a single journal's. The checklist below follows Springer Nature's published manuscript guidelines for book authors, one of the most widely used templates across academic publishers, and mirrors standard practice at comparable houses. Always cross-check the specific volume editor's instructions, which take precedence over any general template.

Formatting checklist

- Abstract: up to 200 words, strongly encouraged even where the publisher makes it optional — it drives the chapter's discoverability online.
- Keywords: 3–6 terms; keep each phrase to no more than two compound words.
- Headings: number consistently using the decimal system (e.g., 3.1, 3.1.2); never skip a level.
- Define technical terms and abbreviations at first use; use SI units throughout.
- Length: commonly 5,000–8,000 words for an edited-volume chapter, but this varies substantially by publisher and volume — confirm with your editor.
- Figures and tables: number consecutively within the chapter (e.g., “Figure 3.1”), each with a self-contained caption.
- References: follow the volume's specified style exactly (many use APA 7th edition); do not cross-reference other chapters by number, since chapters are often sold or accessed individually.
- Do not assume the reader has read other chapters in the volume — repeat essential context.

Chapter — fill in below

Chapter title *Should stand alone — make it meaningful without the book's title.*

Type your chapter title here.

Author(s) & affiliations *Full names, department, institution, city, country.*

First A. Author¹, Second B. Author²

Book title / volume editor(s) *The edited volume this chapter belongs to.*

Book title, edited by ...

Abstract *Up to 200 words summarizing the chapter.*

Summarize the chapter's content here.

Keywords 3–6 terms, each capitalized, comma-separated.

Keyword 1, Keyword 2, Keyword 3

Section outline Numbered headings you plan to use.

1. Introduction 2. ... 3. ... 4. Conclusion

Reference style used As specified by the volume editor.

e.g. APA 7th edition

Figures & tables list Numbered with a one-line caption each.

Figure 3.1: ... / Table 3.1: ...

TEMPLATE 4

Abstract

Structured (IMRaD) format — 200 to 300 words

About this format

A research abstract is a self-contained summary of a study, written so a reader can grasp the question, the approach, the findings, and the significance without reading the full paper. The structured format below is the convention adopted by the International Committee of Medical Journal Editors (ICMJE) and is used by the vast majority of life-science and engineering journals.

Formatting checklist

- Word count: 200–300 words (do not include the title, authors, or keywords in the count).
- One paragraph per heading, or a single paragraph with bold inline headings — follow your venue's rule.
- Write in the past tense for what you did and the present tense for established facts.
- Avoid abbreviations, citations, and figures inside the abstract.
- Numerical results should include units and, where relevant, a measure of variability (SD, 95% CI) and a p-value or effect size.
- 3 to 6 keywords, lower-case, separated by commas, listed in order of importance.

Abstract — fill in below

Title *Concise, specific, ≤ 20 words. Avoid jargon, abbreviations, and question marks.*

Type the title of your study here.

Authors *Full names. Use superscript numbers to link each author to an affiliation.*

First A. Author¹, Second B. Author², Third C. Author¹

Affiliations *Department, institution, city, country — one per line.*

¹ Department of ..., University of ..., City, Country

Corresponding author *Name and institutional email.*

Name, email@institution.edu

Background *1–2 sentences setting the scientific context and the gap your study addresses.*

Why does this problem matter, and what is currently unknown?

Objective / Aim 1 sentence stating the precise research question or hypothesis.

This study aimed to ...

Methods 2–4 sentences on study design, setting, participants/samples, key measurements, and the main analysis.

Describe design, sample, materials, and analytic approach.

Results 2–4 sentences reporting the principal findings with numerical estimates and variability/significance.

Report the main outcome(s) with quantitative detail.

Conclusion 1–2 sentences stating what the results mean and the implication for practice, policy, or further research.

State the take-home message and its significance.

Keywords 3–6 terms, comma-separated.

keyword 1, keyword 2, keyword 3, keyword 4

Conflict of interest If none, write “The authors declare no conflict of interest.”

Disclose any financial or personal relationships that could bias the work.

Funding source Name the funder and grant number, or write “None.”

This work was supported by ...

TEMPLATE 5

Poster

Content blueprint for an A0 / A1 conference poster

About this format

A scientific poster is a single-page visual summary of a study, designed to be read at arm's length and to spark conversation with the author. This template provides the textual content for each standard panel; paste the finished text into your poster software (PowerPoint, Keynote, Illustrator, Canva, Inkscape, or LaTeX/Beamer) at A0 (841 × 1189 mm) or A1 (594 × 841 mm). The design checklist follows the layout recommended by the NIH and the American Medical Writers Association.

Formatting checklist

- Orientation: portrait or landscape — follow the conference rule. If unspecified, portrait is most common.
- Reading flow: top-to-bottom, left-to-right, in three or four columns.
- Font sizes (when printed at A0): title ≥ 72 pt; section headings 36–48 pt; body text 24–32 pt; captions 18–24 pt.
- Word budget: aim for 300–800 words across the whole poster. Less text, more figures.
- Figures and tables should occupy 40–60% of the area. Every figure needs a self-explanatory caption.
- Use a consistent colour palette (3–4 colours) and a sans-serif body font (Arial, Helvetica, Calibri, Lato).
- Ensure colour-blind-safe palettes — avoid red/green contrasts; check with a simulator before printing.

Header block (top of poster)

Poster title ≤ 15 words. Should communicate the finding, not just the topic.

e.g. "A novel low-cost biosensor improves early detection of ..."

Authors Presenting author underlined or marked with an asterisk.

A. Author, B. Author, C. Author*

Affiliations & logos Departments, institutions, funders.

¹ Institution, City, Country • ² Institution, City, Country

Body panels

A typical layout. Replace placeholder text with your content.

1. Introduction / Background 50–100 words. Set the scene; state the gap.

What is known? What is unknown? Why does it matter now?

2. Aim / Research question / Hypothesis 1–2 sentences.

We hypothesised that ...

3. Materials & Methods 80–150 words. A workflow diagram often communicates better than prose.

Design • Sample • Procedure • Analysis. Consider a flowchart.

4. Results Largest panel. Figures with 1–2 sentence captions; minimal narrative.

Figure 1. [Self-contained caption: what it shows and the key finding.]

5. Discussion 80–150 words. What do the results mean? Limitations?

Interpret findings, compare with prior work, acknowledge limits.

6. Conclusions Bullet points, ideally 3.

Finding 1 • Finding 2 • Implication / next step

Footer block (bottom of poster)**References** Key citations only — usually 3 to 6, in a small font.

1. Author A, et al. Journal Year;Vol:pp.

Acknowledgments Funders, participants, technical staff.

This work was supported by ... We thank ... for ...

Contact / QR code Email of presenting author and an optional QR linking to a full PDF or pre-print.

name@institution.edu • ORCID • QR code placeholder

TEMPLATE 6

Article

General / trade publication piece — 800 to 1,500 words

About this format

This template covers an explainer or practice-oriented article for a professional, trade, or general-audience outlet — not a peer-reviewed journal, and not built around a single narrative scene the way a magazine feature is. Think a professional-association newsletter, an industry trade publication, or an online explainer. The goal is to translate research into practical takeaways for a knowledgeable but non-specialist reader, following conventions typical of professional and industry publications.

Formatting checklist

- Word count: typically 800–1,500 words; confirm the target publication's own limit.
- Open with the practical relevance or news peg — why should this reader care right now.
- Structure with clear subheadings: context, the finding or insight, and practical implications for the reader's work.
- Support claims with data or citations, but keep in-text citation light; most trade outlets prefer a short “further reading” list over inline references.
- Write as an explainer for the reader's benefit, not a first-person research narrative — keep “I/we did this” language to a minimum.
- Disclose any funding, employer, or industry relationship relevant to the topic.
- Include an author bio with institutional affiliation, and 2–4 keywords or a category tag if the outlet indexes by topic.

Article — fill in below

Working title *Practical and specific, not just the research topic.*

Type your working title here.

Target publication *Trade publication, newsletter, or online outlet.*

e.g. Industry trade magazine, professional-association newsletter

Practical-relevance hook *Why this reader should care right now.*

Open with the practical relevance or news peg here.

Section outline *Subheaded sections: context, insight, implications.*

1. Context 2. The finding/insight 3. Practical implications

Key data / citations *Data points or sources supporting the piece, kept light.*

List key data points and sources here.

Further reading list *Short list in lieu of inline citations.*

1. Source ... 2. Source ...

Author bio *Name, title, institution, and any relevant disclosure.*

First Last, [title], [institution]. Disclosures: ...

Word count *800–1,500 target.*

___ words

TEMPLATE 7

Journal

Full peer-reviewed manuscript — IMRaD structure

About this format

A journal manuscript is prepared for formal peer review and follows the structure and disclosure requirements set out in the ICMJE Recommendations for the Conduct, Reporting, Editing, and Publication of Scholarly Work in Medical Journals, which more than 5,000 journals worldwide state they follow, and which most non-medical scientific journals also use as a de facto template. This is distinct from the standalone Abstract template earlier in this pack — the Journal template covers the complete manuscript.

Formatting checklist

- Structure: IMRaD — Introduction, Methods, Results, and Discussion — reflecting the process of scientific discovery rather than an arbitrary format; use subheadings within each section as needed.
- Title page (kept separate from the blinded manuscript for double-blind review): full title, all author names and affiliations, corresponding-author contact details, word count, and any disclaimers.
- Abstract: follow the target journal's specific word limit and structured/unstructured format (commonly 200–300 words; some journals require a structured summary with fixed subheadings).
- Authorship: every listed author should meet the ICMJE's criteria — substantial contribution to the work; drafting or critically revising it; final approval of the version submitted; and agreement to be accountable for it.
- Disclosures: complete a conflict-of-interest statement for every author (the ICMJE Disclosure Form is used by ICMJE member journals) and a funding / sources-of-support statement.
- Reporting guideline: use the checklist matching your study design where one exists (e.g., CONSORT for trials, PRISMA for systematic reviews, STROBE for observational studies).
- References: match the target journal's citation style exactly, and verify every citation against the original source.
- Include a data-availability statement, per the target journal's policy.

Manuscript — fill in below

Manuscript title *Include study-design information where relevant (e.g., “a randomized trial”).*

Type your manuscript title here.

Authors & affiliations *Full names, department, institution, city, country.*

First A. Author¹, Second B. Author²

Corresponding author *Name, institutional email, and mailing address.*

Name, email@institution.edu

Target journal *Journal you are submitting to.*

e.g. Journal name

Word count *Per the target journal's limit; state what is / isn't included.*

___ words (excluding abstract, references, tables)

Abstract format & limit *Structured or unstructured, and the word limit.*

e.g. Structured, 250-word limit

Keywords *As required by the target journal.*

keyword 1, keyword 2, keyword 3

Reporting guideline used *e.g. CONSORT, PRISMA, STROBE, ARRIVE — or “N/A.”*

Name the applicable reporting guideline.

Funding statement *Funder and grant number, or “None.”*

This work was supported by ...

Conflict-of-interest disclosure *Per-author disclosure, or “The authors declare no conflict of interest.”*

Disclose relevant relationships for each author.

Data availability statement *Where and how the underlying data can be accessed.*

State the data-availability arrangement here.